



Money On The Table

Sharing Program Income with VR Through
Ticket to Work & Partnership Plus

Presented by Russ Thelin

June 5, 2019



Introduction to Today's Speaker

- 28-years of VR Experience
- Past Executive Director of the Utah State Office of Rehabilitation
- 4-years at ICI as a content expert providing technical assistance to VR, Think College, ID/DD agencies and others.
- And, I am Santa Claus!

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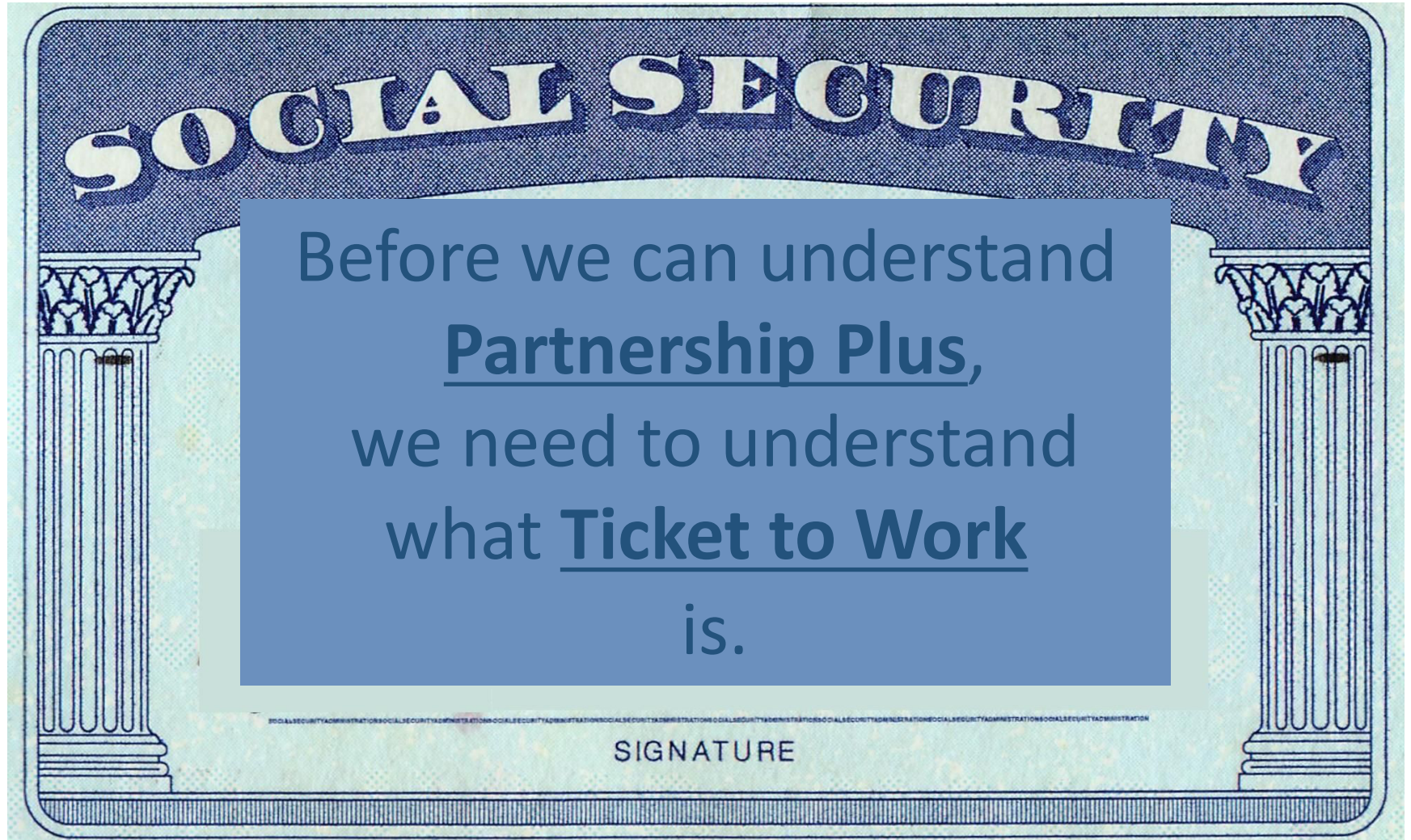




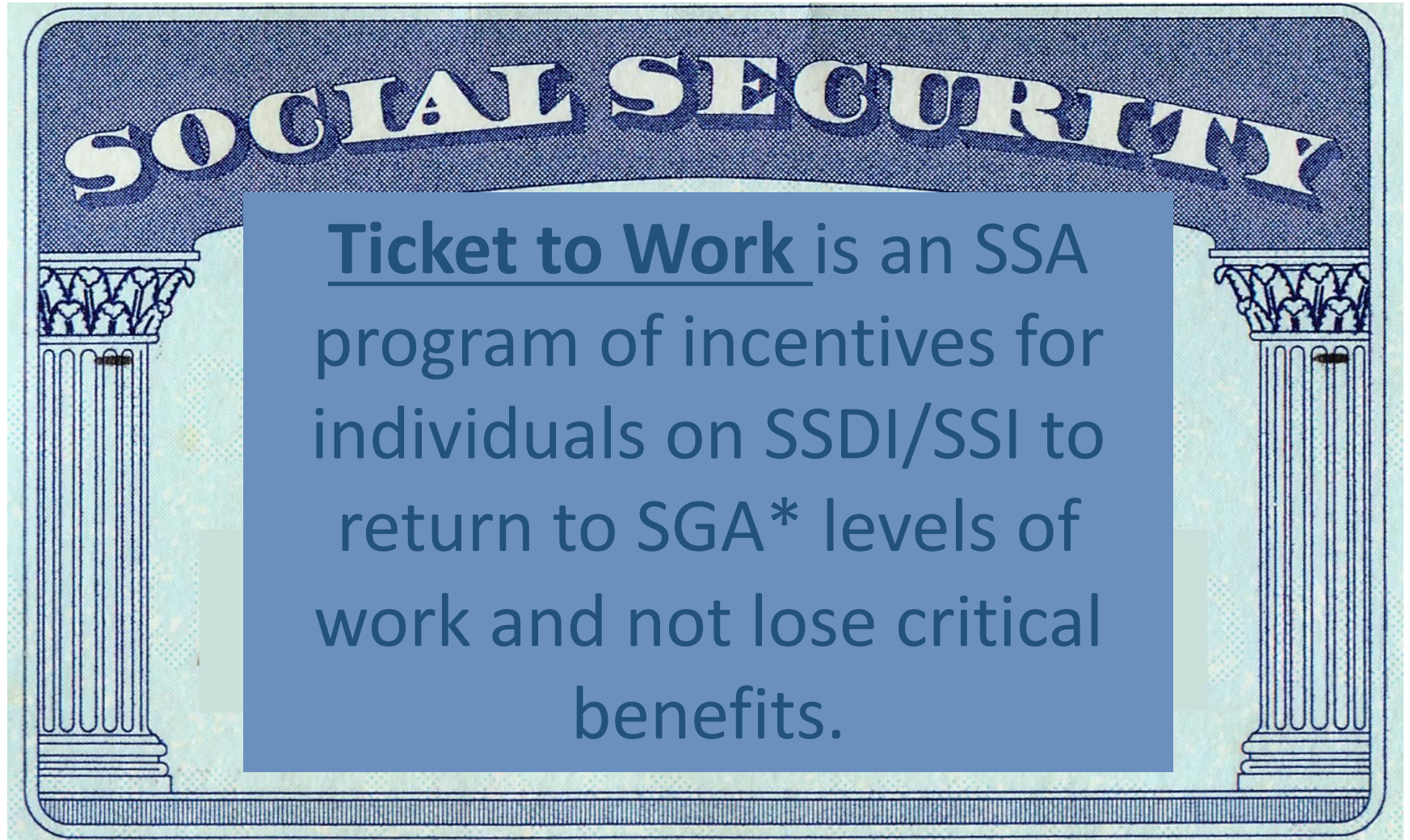
**So, what is
Partnership Plus?**



Partnership Plus?

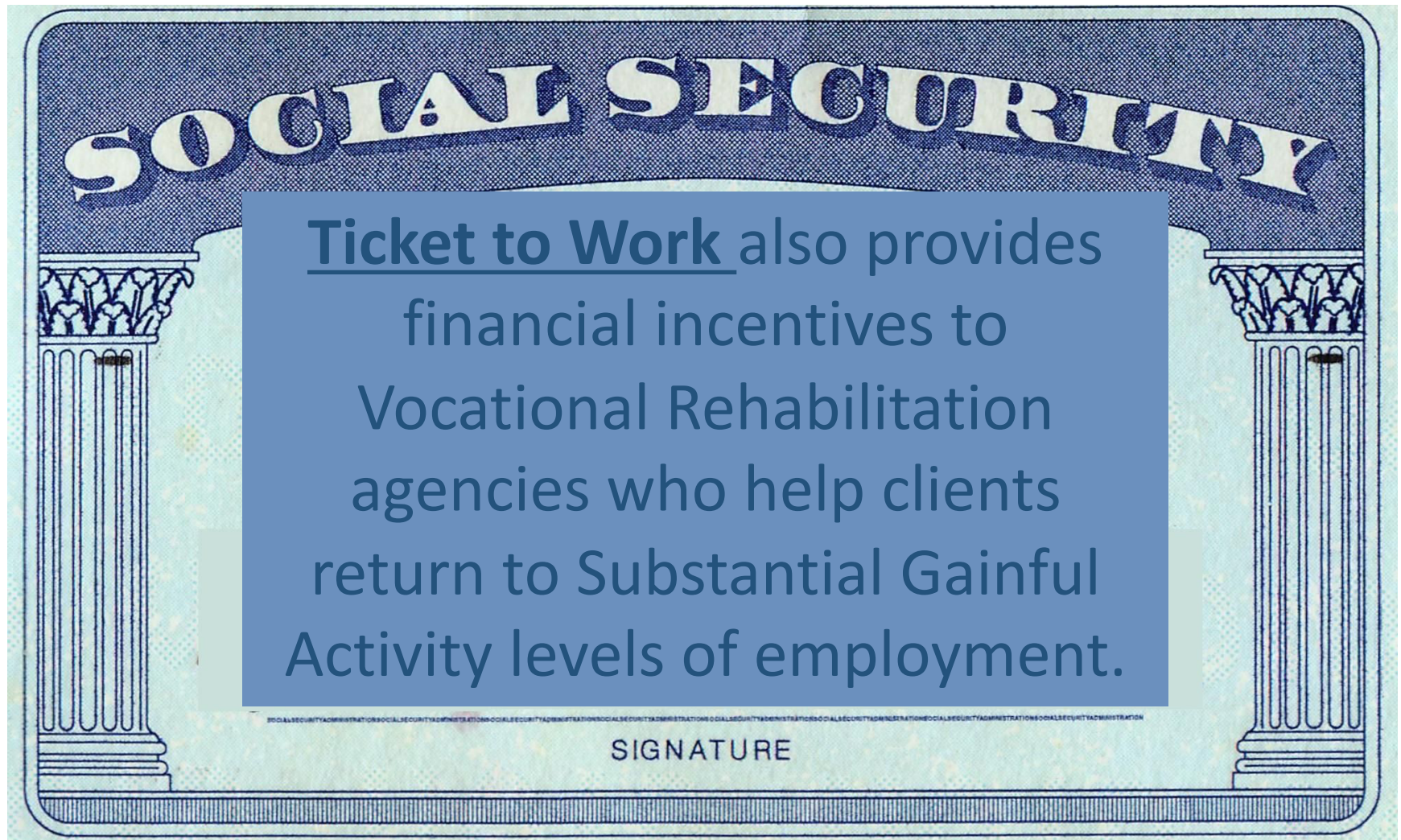


Ticket to Work?



*Substantial Gainful Activity

Ticket to Work?



Cost Reimbursement (CR)*

- State VR reimbursement from SSA when beneficiaries enter the workforce and achieve nine continuous months of SGA. Comprised of:
 - Cost of services provided
 - Counseling costs

*CR not applicable to Partnership Plus

Milestone/Outcome Payments

- Two sets of milestone
- One set of outcome payments
- Reimbursement prior to benefit cessation incentivizes work with beneficiaries to achieve SGA level.
 - Phase I, Trial Work Period
 - Phase II, SGA Work Period
 - Outcome, SSA benefits end

Two Types of TTW Incentives for VR

What If You Are Not VR?



If you're not VR, here is a term for you. . .



T



Employment Network (EN)

- -An SSA approved designation, enabling entities to receive TTW financial incentives.
- -Obtained by completing a request for application (RFA) form and submitting it to the SSA.
- -Businesses, non-VR agencies, non-profits, community rehabilitation programs, and colleges/universities (IHE programs) can all become EN's
- -VR is an automatic EN (no application needed)

To Summarize

- Social Security operates a Ticket to Work program that incentivizes disability benefit recipients to return to work.
- SSA offers financial incentives to VR and others who help beneficiaries obtain Trial and SGA levels of employment earnings.
- In order to take advantage of these financial incentives, non-VR entities must become an approved Employment Network (EN).
- VR has the option of operating as an EN or not.

Let's start talking about Partnership Plus

- Partnership Plus:
 - Takes the TTW model and enables a strategic partnership for sharing services provision and output/outcome rewards.
 - Makes sense for Inclusive Higher Education (IHE) programs and VR agencies who share similar goals of serving beneficiaries toward obtaining & sustaining employment.
 - Provides for collaboration with VR in an innovative and unique way.

Partnership Plus

- Creates a coordinated system of services toward meeting employment potential of beneficiaries.
- Expands and improves communication between providers.
- Provides for sharing of milestone payments between the EN and VR.



So where is the jingle, you ask . . .

For the next few slides we will break down the TTW payments by phase I, phase II, and outcome milestones. These are total potential payments. We will discuss the how they are split between the EN and VR and provide examples later.

Phase I Milestones	SSDI (Title II) and SSI Payments	Beneficiary Gross Income
P1/M1	\$1,409	\$850 x 1 month
P1/M2	\$1,409	\$850 x 3 months w/in 6 months
P1/M3	\$1,409	\$850 x 6 months w/in 12 months
P1/M4	\$1,409	\$850 x 9 months w/in 18 months
Total Potential P1M pmts.	\$5,636	

So where is the jingle, you ask . . .

Phase II: A beneficiary must earn at or above the SGA level for an EN to qualify for Phase 2 milestone payments. The monthly payment to the EN and the duration of these payments vary depending on the type of disability benefits the beneficiary receives (SSDI or SSI).

Disability Type	Phase II Milestones	Phase II Payment
SSDI	Up to 11 months SGA at \$423/month	(\$423 x 11) \$4,653
SSI	Up to 18 months SGA at \$242/month	(\$242 x 18) \$4,356

So where is the jingle, you ask . . .

Outcome Payments are available when a beneficiary has earnings above SGA and disability benefits cease due to work and earnings. The monthly outcome payment to the EN and the duration of these payments varies depending on the type of disability benefits the beneficiary receives.

Disability Type	Phase II Milestones	Phase II Payment
SSDI	Up to 36 months at \$423/month	(\$423 x 36) \$15,228
SSI	Up to 60 months at \$242/month	(\$242 x 60) \$14,520

The Total Possible Jingle

Combining maximum possible milestone payments paints a picture of amounts potentially left on the table (actually going wholly to VR) by not becoming an EN and partnering for some of it.

Milestone	SSDI Total TTW Potential Payment	SSI Total Potential TTW Payment
Phase I	\$5,613	\$5,613
Phase II	\$4,653	\$4,356
Outcome	\$15,228	\$14,520
TOTAL	\$25,494	\$24,489



Social Security Disability Insurance (SSDI)

Milestone	Total PP Payments	Split 10/90	Split 20/80	Split 30/70	Split 40/60	Split 50/50
SSDI PI	\$5,636.00	564 / 5072	1127 / 4509	1691 / 3945	2254 / 3382	2818 / 2818
SSDI PII	\$4,653.00	465 / 4188	931 / 3722	1396 / 3257	1861 / 2792	2327 / 2326
SSDI Outcome	\$15,228.00	1523 / 13705	3046 / 12182	4568 / 10660	6091 / 9137	7614 / 7614
TOTAL SSDI	\$25,494.00	2549 / 22945	5099 / 20395	7648 / 17846	10198 / 15269	12747 / 12747

Example One:

Milestone	VR	IHE-EN	Split
SSDI Phase I	4509	1127	80/20
SSDI Phase II	3257	1396	70/30
SSDI Outcome	4568	10660	30/70
TOTAL SSDI	12334	13183	49/51



Supplemental Security Income (SSI)

Milestone	Total PP Payments	Split 10/90	Split 20/80	Split 30/70	Split 40/60	Split 50/50
SSI PI	\$5,636.00	564 / 5072	1127 / 4509	1691 / 3945	2254 / 3382	2818 / 2818
SSI PII	\$4,356.00	436 / 3920	871 / 3485	1307 / 3048	1714 / 2642	2178 / 2178
SSI Outcome	\$14,520.00	1452 / 13068	2904 / 11616	4356 / 10164	5908 / 8712	7260 / 7260
TOTAL SSI	\$24,489.00	2449 / 22040	4898 / 19491	7347 / 17142	9796 / 14693	12244 / 1225

Example Two:

Milestone	VR	IHE-EN	Split
SSI Phase I	5636	0	100/0
SSI Phase II	2178	2178	50/50
SSI Outcome	2904	11616	20/80
TOTAL SSI	10718	13794	43/57



OK, You Try It!

What makes Sense?

Milestone	Total PP Payments	Split 10/90	Split 20/80	Split 30/70	Split 40/60	Split 50/50
SSI PI	\$5,636.00	564 / 5072	1127 / 4509	1691 / 3945	2254 / 3382	2818 / 2818
SSI PII	\$4,356.00	436 / 3920	871 / 3485	1307 / 3048	1714 / 2642	2178 / 2178
SSI Outcome	\$14,520.00	1452 / 13068	2904 / 11616	4356 / 10164	5908 / 8712	7260 / 7260
TOTAL SSI	\$24,489.00	2449 / 22040	4898 / 19491	7347 / 17142	9796 / 14693	12244 / 1225

Example Two:

Milestone	VR	IHE-EN	Split
SSI Phase I			
SSI Phase II			
SSI Outcome			
TOTAL SSI			



Tom works with VR and attends IHE for job skills



IHE
as an
Employment Network (EN)

SSA pays IHE-EN and VR programs Outcome milestone payments monthly as outlined in Partnership Plus agreement.

An employer has a job opening



Tom uses skills from VR and IHE experiences to secure employment

Up to \$25,494
(SSDI)
or \$24,489 (SSI)
over
3-5 years



Tom reduces his Social Security benefits



EN and VR work with Tom at his job (Phase I milestone payments received as outlined in Partnership Plus agreement)



Tom is succeeding in his job (Phase II milestone payments received monthly as Outlined in Partnership Plus agreement)

Becoming an EN



- Consider talking to your VR agency on your intent, first.
- Complete a request for application (RFA) with SSA.

<https://www.ssa.gov/work/enrfa.html>

R E S O U R C E S



Ticket to Work:

<https://yourtickettowork.ssa.gov/index.html>

Partnership Plus:

<https://yourtickettowork.ssa.gov/program-operations/partnership-plus.html>

The Center is funded by the US Department of Education, Office of Postsecondary Education, Grant #P407B15002.

Here is an online resource available to you regarding Partnership Plus

<https://thinkcollege.net/sites/default/files/files/resources/Are We Leaving Money on the Table-IB39.pdf>

INSIGHT

A Think College Brief on Policy, Research, & Practice



Are We Leaving Money on the Table? How Partnership Plus May Boost the Fiscal Stability of Inclusive Higher Education Programs

By Russ Thelin

Fiscal sustainability is a critical aspect to maintain quality and consistency for students with intellectual and/or developmental disability (IDD) who are accessing higher education. Colleges and universities use multiple means to meet their program costs, including state and federal funds, foundation monies, Medicaid waivers, vocational rehabilitation (VR) funds, and scholarships.

One underused financial resource is the Partnership Plus model provided under the Ticket to Work program of the Social Security Administration (SSA). Partnership Plus is a structured services provision model between VR and other entities to assist SSA beneficiaries to employment, with compensation from SSA provided to each.

This brief will describe what Partnership Plus is, explain how it works, and illustrate how institutions of higher education (IHEs) already partnering with VR could build upon this partnership to gain program income.

Interested steps in becoming an EN

Identify potential partners within your IHE and then others within your institution to determine if it is in your best programmatic and financial interest to become an EN.

Consult with your VR agency regarding your IHE becoming an EN, and enter into a Partnership Plus agreement with them.

Complete the SSA EN Request for Quotation (ENRFQ) form (<https://yourtickettowork/enrfq.html>).

Submit the completed form through to receive determination of EN status for designation as an EN.

Complete no-cost SSA provided services for designated EN. (<https://yourtickettowork/enrfq.html>)

Establishing a Partnership Plus agreement can be found at the end of this brief.

The Ticket to Work and Work Incentives Improvement Act of 1999 increased the options for individuals with disabilities who wish to return to work. Commonly referred to as "Ticket," the regulatory language supporting this legislation has undergone several revisions.

The 2008 Ticket regulations included provisions to create financial incentives for state VR agencies and approved Employment Networks (ENs) to work collaboratively to assist beneficiaries to achieve long-term employment success with compensation for doing so. Known as Partnership Plus, this financial incentives model allows VR and an EN to share the compensation from SSA for employment of beneficiaries as they reach successful levels of employment. As beneficiaries achieve partial milestones toward Substantial Gainful Activity¹ (SGA) and sustained employment at the level of SGA, milestone and outcome payments are provided to the participating Partnership Plus entities.

Employment Network status can be given to organizations that meet and sustain Social Security definitions and standards. An EN may be any public or private entity as long as the EN is qualified to assume responsibility for coordination with VR, services delivery, or other support services to beneficiaries to help them achieve their employment goals. An EN may be an individual, agency, organization, business, or consortium. Certain entities like State Vocational Rehabilitation (VR) agencies and Department of Labor American Job Centers (formerly known as One Stop career centers), are automatically qualified as ENs under the Ticket Program. Federal agencies are precluded from becoming ENs and beneficiaries may be qualified and approved as ENs, are precluded from acting as their own EN.

¹Substantial Gainful Activity is the amount of monthly earnings SSA considers to warrant provision of outcome payments under Partnership Plus. This amount is updated annually, and consists of two SGA amounts (one each for blind and non-blind recipients). The 2018 monthly SGA amounts are \$1,970 for blind recipients and \$1,260 for non-blind. SGA amounts for subsequent years can be found at www.ssa.gov.

The background of the image is filled with numerous red question marks of varying sizes and orientations, creating a dense, chaotic pattern. In the center, there is a solid orange rectangular box.

QUESTIONS?



The VR Affinity Group

An online community for review and discussion of issues, strategies, and results related to the partnership between VR agencies and IHEs



For more information contact Russ Thelin at:
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*Want to learn
more?*

www.thinkcollege.net

*Need Advice?
Think College
can help...*

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Thank you!

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